

DUVO - Pre-meeting brief

Ahold Delhaize

Bram de Vries - Chief Commercial Officer

ACCOUNT SIGNAL: HOT

Stack (Sumble): Stack: Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism, Celonis, Microsoft Power Automate, Pega, SAP, ServiceNow, UiPath. RPA platforms: Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism, Pega, UiPath. Automation job posts: 1090 (recently hiring: yes).

THE ANGLE

Ahold Delhaize runs one of the most mature enterprise automation stacks in European retail - Automation Anywhere (65+ bots, 69K+ FTE hours saved in RBS/USA), Blue Prism, UiPath, Pega, Power Automate, layered on SAP and ServiceNow, with Celonis for process mining. 1,090 open automation roles signals active scaling, not exploration. The Q3 pain around supplier operations gaps lands directly in this stack: P2P/AP processes are already partially automated, but Celonis process mining likely surfaced execution gaps between supplier touchpoints and RPA coverage. As CCO, Bram de Vries owns commercial supplier relationships and the EUR3B complementary income stream target - automation gaps in supplier ops are his margin and velocity problem. Active vendor evaluation means Duvo must differentiate on outcomes, not features.

DISCOVERY QUESTIONS

1. The Q3 review surfaced supplier operations gaps - were those gaps primarily in data exchange and onboarding latency with suppliers, or in the internal workflows (AP, inventory, compliance) that sit downstream of supplier interactions?
2. You're running Automation Anywhere, UiPath, Blue Prism, and Pega simultaneously - is that intentional specialization by function, or has the stack grown organically and created orchestration overhead that's slowing down new automation deployments in commercial ops?
3. Celonis is a strong signal that you're doing process mining - what did the mining surface in supplier-facing workflows that existing RPA bots aren't covering, and is that the gap that triggered this vendor evaluation?
4. The Growing Together strategy targets EUR5B in savings by 2028 and EUR3B in complementary income streams - how much of the supplier operations gap is a cost-efficiency problem versus a revenue-at-risk problem (e.g., delayed supplier activations slowing retail media or own-brand launches)?
5. With 15,000+ direct suppliers and joint sourcing scaling across six European markets, what does 'good' look like for supplier operations automation in 18 months - and what's the internal benchmark you're using to evaluate vendors against each other?

SOURCES

- Ahold Delhaize RPA Case Study - Automation Anywhere (RBS saves 69,000+ FTE hours) (<https://www.automationanywhere.com/resources/customer-stories/ahold>)
- Ahold Delhaize Growing Together Strategy - Annual Report 2025 (EUR5B savings target, AI/automation in supplier and back-office ops) (<https://aholddelhaize.com/digitalannualreport/2025/documents/Our-Growing-Together-strategy---annual-report-2025.pdf>)
- Joint Sourcing for Affordable, Healthy and Sustainable Food in Europe (15,000+ suppliers, scaling own-brand and sourcing complexity) (<https://newsroom.aholddelhaize.com/joint-sourcing-for-more-affordable-healthy-and-sustainable-food-in-europe/>)